OFFICIAL LANGUAGE

PART XVII SETTLEMENT: OFFICIAL — ARTICLES 343-344 AND THE → OFFICIAL LANGUAGES ACT 1963 → ARTICLES 345-347: STATE CHOICE → ARTICLES 348-349: COURTS, JUDGMENTS → AUTHORITATIVE-TEXT HIERARCHY ACROSS CONSTITUTION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g3 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

PART XVII SETTLEMENT: OFFICIAL LANGUAGE WITHOUT A NATIONAL LANGUAGE

PART XVII SETTLEMENT · OFFICIAL LANGUAGE WITHOUT A NATIONAL LANGUAGE · ROOT QUESTION · HOW DOES ONE UNION PRESERVE COMMON ADMINISTRATION WITHOUT LINGUISTIC · PART XVII · CHAPTER I · ARTICLES 343-344 · UNION LANGUAGE.

ROOT QUESTION

How does one Union preserve common administration without linguistic uniformity? → PART XVII → Chapter I: Articles 343-344

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ROOT QUESTION
- How does one Union preserve common administration without linguistic uniformity?
- PART XVII
- Chapter I: Articles 343-344
- Union language.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Chapter II: Articles 345-347
- regional languages.
- Chapter III: Articles 348-349
- courts and authoritative legal texts.
- Chapter IV: Articles 350-351

CHECK / LIMIT
- grievances, minorities and Hindi development.
- CORE DISTINCTIONS
- Union official language != national language.
- scheduled != official everywhere
- classical != scheduled

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- policy != Constitution.
- Hindi in Devanagari + international form of Indian numerals paired with statutory continuation of English and federal safeguards.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hindi in Devanagari + international form of Indian numerals paired with statutory continuation of English and federal safeguards.

01

STAGE 01

ARTICLES 343-344 AND THE STATUTORY CONTINUATION OF ENGLISH

ARTICLES 343-344 AND THE STATUTORY CONTINUATION OF ENGLISH · ARTICLE 343 · HINDI IN DEVANAGARI · OFFICIAL LANGUAGE OF UNION. · INTERNATIONAL FORM OF INDIAN NUMERALS · OFFICIAL NUMERAL FORM. · ENGLISH TRANSITION PERIOD DID NOT CREATE AN AUTOMATIC 1965 · OFFICIAL LANGUAGES ACT 1963, AS AMENDED SECTION 3 CONTINUES

ARTICLE 343 → Hindi in Devanagari = official language of Union. → international form of Indian numerals = official numeral form. → English transition period did not create an automatic 1965 switch-off. → OFFICIAL LANGUAGES ACT 1963, AS AMENDED section 3 continues English for Union official purposes and

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ARTICLE 343
- Hindi in Devanagari = official language of Union.
- International form of Indian numerals = official numeral form.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- English transition period did not create an automatic 1965 switch-off.
- OFFICIAL LANGUAGES ACT 1963, AS AMENDED section 3 continues English for Union official purposes and parliamentary business.
- section 3(5) uses a high-consent legislative lock for specified discontinuance.

CHECK / LIMIT
- ARTICLE 344
- President's Commission at five years and ten years from commencement.
- 30-member constitutional parliamentary committee 20 Lok Sabha + 10 Rajya Sabha.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- DO NOT COLLAPSE
- Article 344 committee != section 4 statutory Committee on Official Language.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 344 committee != section 4 statutory Committee on Official Language.

02

STAGE 02

OFFICIAL LANGUAGES ACT 1963: CONTINUATION, COMMUNICATION AND CONSENT LOCK

OFFICIAL LANGUAGES ACT 1963 · CONTINUATION, COMMUNICATION AND CONSENT LOCK · SECTION 3 · ENGLISH CONTINUES IN ADDITION TO HINDI FOR SPECIFIED UNION · UNION TO NON-HINDI-OFFICIAL-LANGUAGE STATE · HINDI STATE TO NON-HINDI STATE IN HINDI · ACCOMPANYING ENGLISH TRANSLATION. · ADMINISTRATIVE SAFEGUARDS SECTION 3(2) TRANSLATION

SECTION 3

English continues in addition to Hindi for specified Union purposes and parliamentary business. → Union to non-Hindi-official-language State → English. → Hindi State to non-Hindi State in Hindi → accompanying English translation.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- SECTION 3
- English continues in addition to Hindi for specified Union purposes and parliamentary business.
- Union to non-Hindi-official language State → English.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Hindi State to non-Hindi State in Hindi → accompanying English translation.
- ADMINISTRATIVE SAFEGUARDS section 3(2) translation
- 3(3) bilingual instruments

CHECK / LIMIT
- 3(4) efficiency, public interest and employee non-disadvantage.
- SECTION 3(5) LOCK all specified State Legislatures + Lok Sabha + Rajya Sabha
- Executive preference, one State or one House cannot discontinue the protected use.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Hindi State to non-Hindi State in Hindi → accompanying English translation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Executive preference, one State or one House cannot discontinue the protected use.

03

STAGE 03

ARTICLES 345-347: STATE CHOICE AND INTERGOVERNMENTAL COMMUNICATION

ARTICLES 345-347 · STATE CHOICE AND INTERGOVERNMENTAL COMMUNICATION · ARTICLE 345 · STATE LEGISLATURE MAY ADOPT ONE OR MORE LANGUAGES IN · ENGLISH CONTINUES UNTIL STATE LAW OTHERWISE PROVIDES WITHIN THE · ARTICLE 346 · UNION-STATE AND INTER-STATE COMMUNICATION FOLLOWS THE AUTHORISED UNION LANGUAGE · ARTICLE 347

ARTICLE 345

State Legislature may adopt one or more languages in use in the State, or Hindi. → English continues until State law otherwise provides within the constitutional frame. → ARTICLE 346

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ARTICLE 345
- State Legislature may adopt one or more languages in use in the State, or Hindi.
- English continues until State law otherwise provides within the constitutional frame.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- ARTICLE 346
- Union-State and inter-State communication follows the authorised Union language, subject to agreement permitting Hindi between States.
- ARTICLE 347

CHECK / LIMIT
- President may recognise a language for specified State purposes on substantial demand grounds.
- Eighth-Schedule inclusion is not a prerequisite for State official-language choice.
- Article 347 is not automatic recognition or a general national-language declaration.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- ARTICLE 346

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 347 is not automatic recognition or a general national-language declaration.

04

STAGE 04

ARTICLES 348-349: COURTS, JUDGMENTS AND AUTHORITATIVE TEXTS

ARTICLES 348-349 · COURTS, JUDGMENTS AND AUTHORITATIVE TEXTS · ARTICLE 348 BASELINE · ENGLISH FOR SUPREME COURT AND HIGH COURT PROCEEDINGS UNTIL · ENGLISH AUTHORITATIVE TEXTS FOR BILLS, ACTS, ORDINANCES, ORDERS, RULES · HIGH COURT PROCEEDINGS · GOVERNOR + PREVIOUS PRESIDENTIAL CONSENT · HINDI OR STATE OFFICIAL LANGUAGE.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ARTICLE 348 BASELINE
- English for Supreme Court and High Court proceedings until Parliament provides otherwise.
- English authoritative texts for Bills, Acts, ordinances, orders, rules and bye-laws.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- HIGH COURT PROCEEDINGS
- Governor + previous presidential consent → Hindi or State official language.
- Article 348(2) expressly excludes judgments, decrees and orders.

CHECK / LIMIT
- SECTION 7 ROUTE authorised non-English High Court judgment/decree/order in addition to English
- High Court-authorised English translation.
- ARTICLE 349 historically time-bounded special procedure; not a routine present-day gate.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- LIMIT machine or general-information translation is not authentically authoritative law.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT machine or general-information translation is not automatically authoritative law.

05

STAGE 05

AUTHORITATIVE-TEXT HIERARCHY ACROSS CONSTITUTION AND STATUTES

AUTHORITATIVE-TEXT HIERARCHY ACROSS CONSTITUTION AND STATUTES · ENGLISH BASELINE · ARTICLE 348(1) · COURT PROCEEDINGS AND AUTHORITATIVE LEGISLATIVE/DELEGATED TEXTS · HINDI ROUTES · 1963 ACT SECTION 5 · AUTHORISED HINDI CENTRAL TEXTS. · SECTION 6

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
ENGLISH BASELINE	1963 Act section 5: authorised Hindi Central texts.	Authoritative Texts (Central Laws) Act 1973	TRAP translation utility, including machine output, does not itself confer authority.
Article 348(1): court proceedings and authoritative legislative/delegated texts.	section 6: authorised Hindi State text in specified cases.	Presidential authority + Official Gazette → authoritative Central law translation.	
HINDI ROUTES	OTHER SCHEDULED LANGUAGES	HIGH COURT JUDGMENTS section 7: authorised non-English judgment + High Court-authorised English translation.	

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ENGLISH BASELINE
- Article 348(1): court proceedings and authoritative legislative/delegated texts.
- HINDI ROUTES

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 1963 Act section 5: authorised Hindi Central texts.
- section 6: authorised Hindi State text in specified cases.
- OTHER SCHEDULED LANGUAGES

CHECK / LIMIT
- Authoritative Texts (Central Laws) Act 1973
- Presidential authority + Official Gazette → authoritative Central-law translation.
- HIGH COURT JUDGMENTS section 7: authorised non-English judgment + High Court-authorised English translation.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- TRAP translation utility, including machine output, does not itself confer authority.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP translation utility, including machine output, does not itself confer authority.

06

STAGE 06

ARTICLES 350, 350A, 350B AND 351: ACCESS AND DEVELOPMENT

ARTICLES 350, 350A, 350B AND 351 · ACCESS AND DEVELOPMENT · ARTICLE 350 REPRESENTATION FOR GRIEVANCE REDRESS MAY USE A · ARTICLE 350A ENDEAVOUR TO PROVIDE MOTHER-TONGUE INSTRUCTION FACILITIES AT · ARTICLE 350B · SPECIAL OFFICER INVESTIGATES SAFEGUARDS · REPORTS TO PRESIDENT · LAID BEFORE PARLIAMENT AND SENT TO CONCERNED STATE GOVERNMENTS.

ARTICLE 350 representation for grievance redress may use a language used in the Union or → ARTICLE 350B → Special Officer investigates safeguards → reports to President

ARTICLE 350A endeavour to provide mother-tongue instruction facilities at primary stage for children belonging to

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ARTICLE 350 representation for grievance redress may use a language used in the Union or State.
- ARTICLE 350A endeavour to provide mother-tongue instruction facilities at primary stage for children belonging to linguistic-minority groups.
- ARTICLE 350B

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Special Officer investigates safeguards → reports to President
- laid before Parliament and sent to concerned State governments.
- ARTICLE 351

CHECK / LIMIT
- Union duty to promote Hindi and develop it as a medium for India's
- composite culture, drawing vocabulary principally from Sanskrit and secondarily from other languages.
- BALANCE promotion of Hindi operates with, not above, plural safeguards and federal consent.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Special Officer investigates safeguards → reports to President

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BALANCE promotion of Hindi operates with, not above, plural safeguards and federal consent.

07

STAGE 07

OFFICIAL LANGUAGES RULES 1976: ADMINISTRATIVE ROUTING WITHOUT HIERARCHY

OFFICIAL LANGUAGES RULES 1976 · ADMINISTRATIVE ROUTING WITHOUT HIERARCHY · RULES 1976 OFFICIAL PORTAL SHOWS AMENDMENTS IN 1987, 2007 · FIRST QUESTION · CENTRAL OFFICE TO NON-CENTRAL RECIPIENT · RULE 3 AND REGION A/B/C. · CENTRAL OFFICE TO CENTRAL OFFICE · RULE 4.

RULES 1976 official portal shows amendments in 1987, 2007 and 2011; extent excludes Tamil Nadu.

FIRST QUESTION → Central office to non-Central recipient → Rule 3 and Region A/B/C. → Central office to Central office → Rule 4.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- RULES 1976 official portal shows amendments in 1987, 2007 and 2011; extent excludes Tamil Nadu.
- FIRST QUESTION
- Central office to non-Central recipient → Rule 3 and Region A/B/C.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Central office to Central office → Rule 4.
- DOCUMENT CONTROLS reply to Hindi → Hindi
- section 3(3) documents → Hindi + English.

CHECK / LIMIT
- applications/file notes → employee safeguards under Rules 7-8.
- CURRENT CAUTION
- A/B/C are administrative communication categories, not constitutional rankings.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Do not silently modernise territorial names beyond the authoritative rule text.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Do not silently modernise territorial names beyond the authoritative rule text.

08

STAGE 08

EIGHTH SCHEDULE, CLASSICAL STATUS AND THE THREE-LANGUAGE POLICY BOUNDARY

EIGHTH SCHEDULE, CLASSICAL STATUS AND THE THREE-LANGUAGE POLICY BOUNDARY · EIGHTH SCHEDULE · 22 LANGUAGES IN THE CURRENT OFFICIAL CONSTITUTION. · 14 ORIGINAL · ORIYA RENAMED ODIA. · EFFECT CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION AND ARTICLE 344/351 RELEVANCE. · NO AUTOMATIC UNION, STATE, COURT OR SCHOOL-MEDIUM STATUS FOLLOWS. · CLASSICAL STATUS SEPARATE UNION EXECUTIVE RECOGNITION.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
EIGHTH SCHEDULE	Oriya renamed Odia.	CLASSICAL STATUS separate Union executive recognition.	It is not a constitutional national-language command.
22 languages in the current official Constitution.	EFFECT constitutional recognition and Article 344/351 relevance.	October 2024 additions brought the official count then reported to eleven.	
14 original → Sindhi → Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali → Bodo/Dogri/Maithili/Santhali	No automatic Union, State, court or school-medium status follows.	THREE-LANGUAGE FORMULA education-policy framework with State implementation variation.	

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- EIGHTH SCHEDULE
- 22 languages in the current official Constitution.
- 14 original → Sindhi → Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali → Bodo/Dogri/Maithili/Santhali

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Oriya renamed Odia.
- EFFECT constitutional recognition and Article 344/351 relevance.
- No automatic Union, State, court or school-medium status follows.

CHECK / LIMIT
- CLASSICAL STATUS separate Union executive recognition.
- October 2024 additions brought the official count then reported to eleven.
- THREE-LANGUAGE FORMULA education-policy framework with State implementation variation.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- It is not a constitutional national-language command.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: THREE-LANGUAGE FORMULA education-policy framework with State implementation variation.

09

STAGE 09

LANGUAGE CASES: COMPETENCE, MINORITY CONTEXT AND PROTECTED CHOICE

LANGUAGE CASES · COMPETENCE, MINORITY CONTEXT AND PROTECTED CHOICE · GUJARAT UNIVERSITY V. SHRI KRISHNA (1963) MEDIUM/LANGUAGE POWER MUST · D.A.V. COLLEGE V. STATE OF PUNJAB (1971) LINGUISTIC-MINORITY SAFEGUARDS · STATE OF KARNATAKA V. ASSOCIATED MANAGEMENT (2014) COMPULSORY MOTHER-TONGUE · DOCTRINAL TRIANGLE LEGISLATIVE COMPETENCE · SPEECH/CHOICE RIGHTS · LINGUISTIC-MINORITY SAFEGUARDS.

Gujarat University v. Shri Krishna (1963) medium/language power must respect the Union-State education competence boundary. → D.A.V. College v. State of Punjab (1971) linguistic-minority safeguards require contextual constitutional analysis. → State of Karnataka v. Associated Management (2014) compulsory mother-tongue medium cannot override protected educational choice. → DOCTRINAL TRIANGLE legislative competence → speech/choice rights

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- Gujarat University v. Shri Krishna (1963) medium/language power must respect the Union-State education competence boundary.
- D.A.V. College v. State of Punjab (1971) linguistic-minority safeguards require contextual constitutional analysis.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- State of Karnataka v. Associated Management (2014) compulsory mother-tongue medium cannot override protected educational choice.
- DOCTRINAL TRIANGLE legislative competence

CHECK / LIMIT
- speech/choice rights
- linguistic-minority safeguards.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- LIMIT none of these decisions declares a national language or erases Article 350A.
- Gujarat University v. Shri Krishna (1963) medium/language power must respect the Union-State education competence boundary.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT none of these decisions declares a national language or erases Article 350A.

10

STAGE 10

FEDERAL ACCOMMODATION, COURT ACCESS AND TRANSLATION TECHNOLOGY

FEDERAL ACCOMMODATION, COURT ACCESS AND TRANSLATION TECHNOLOGY · LEGITIMATE GOALS ADMINISTRATIVE INTEROPERABILITY · CITIZEN ACCESS · CULTURAL RECOGNITION JUDICIAL USABILITY · EDUCATIONAL INCLUSION. · RISKS IMPOSITION · EXCLUSION FROM EMPLOYMENT/SERVICES · TRANSLATION ERROR AUTHORITATIVE-TEXT CONFUSION

LEGITIMATE GOALS administrative interoperability

citizen access → cultural recognition judicial usability → educational inclusion.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- LEGITIMATE GOALS administrative interoperability
- citizen access
- cultural recognition judicial usability
- educational inclusion.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- RISKS imposition
- exclusion from employment/services
- translation error authoritative-text confusion
- weak minority facilities

CHECK / LIMIT
- digital language divide.
- TECHNOLOGY CHAIN multilingual intake → translation/interpretation → human legal review
- authority label → version control → accessible publication
- FEDERAL METHOD consent + capacity + phased implementation + reciprocal communication.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- LIMIT policy targets, committee recommendations and software outputs do not amend Part XVII.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT policy targets, committee recommendations and software outputs do not amend Part XVII.

11

STAGE 11

UPSC TRAPS, VERIFIED PYQ AND QUALIFIED ANSWER SYNTHESIS

UPSC TRAPS, VERIFIED PYQ AND QUALIFIED ANSWER SYNTHESIS · PRELIMS FIREWALL OFFICIAL · 22 SCHEDULED LANGUAGES · HINDI SCRIPT · DEVANAGARI NUMERALS · INTERNATIONAL FORM · ENGLISH CONTINUATION · ARTICLE 348(2) EXCLUDES JUDGMENTS · PRELIMS FIREWALL official != national

PRELIMS FIREWALL official != national → 22 scheduled languages → Hindi script + Devanagari numerals + international form → English continuation + statute → Article 348(2) excludes judgments

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PRELIMS FIREWALL official != national
- 22 scheduled languages
- Hindi script + Devanagari numerals + international form
- English continuation + statute

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Article 348(2) excludes judgments
- section 7 supplies separate route
- Article 350 grievance right
- 350A instruction facility

CHECK / LIMIT
- 350B Special Officer classical and three-language categories are separate.
- 2024 PRELIMS ROUTE
- 21st, 71st and 92nd Amendment language additions.
- MAINS SPINE constitutional compromise → Part XVII → 1963 Act

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- State autonomy → court/text hierarchy → minority safeguards
- category distinctions → access technology → federal verdict.
- CONCLUSION multilingual unity requires exact law, consent and authoritative parity.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — category distinctions → access technology → federal verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONCLUSION multilingual unity requires exact law, consent and authoritative parity.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (ARTS 343–344) · PART B — REGIONAL LANGUAGES (ARTS 345–347) · PART C — LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (ARTS · PART D — SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (ARTS 350–351) · PART E — THE EIGHTH SCHEDULE · ART 343 · UNION IN DEVANAGARI SCRIPT

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE
- PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (Arts 343–344)
- PART B — REGIONAL LANGUAGES (Arts 345–347)
- PART C — LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (Arts 348–349)
- PART D — SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (Arts 350–351)

ADVANCED LIMIT
- PART E — THE EIGHTH SCHEDULE
- Art 343: Hindi in Devanagari script + official language of the Union ; numerals = the international form of Indian numerals . not the Devanagari form.
- English to continue for 15 years (1950–1965) ; Parliament may extend its use beyond that.
- Language Commissions (5th & 10th year) first under B.G. Kher (1955) ; examined by a parliamentary

COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- Official Languages Act, 1963 — continues English in addition to Hindi for specified Union purposes and parliamentary business;
- Constitution does not specify states' official languages — a state legislature may adopt any language(s)
- A state's choice is NOT limited to the Eighth Schedule (e.g., states have adopted non-8th-Schedule tongues).
- Art 347: On demand, if a substantial population wants it, the President may direct official recognition of

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels